MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検準2級
リーディングトレーニング

第12回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全29問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜15	短文の語句空所補充
2	16〜20	会話文の空所補充
3	21〜22	長文の語句空所補充
4	23〜29	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検準2級形式のリーディング第12回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) The librarian asked the boys to ( ) their voices near the study cubicles.

1 locate **2** loosen **3** lengthen **4** lower

(2) By the ( ) we reached the summit, morning mist had cleared completely.

1 hour **2** time **3** moment **4** period

(3) This herbal throat candy provides quick ( ) when you have a dry cough.

1 contract **2** conflict **3** comfort **4** conduct

(4) My sister speaks Spanish almost as ( ) as our cousin in Madrid.

1 fluently **2** fluent **3** fluency **4** more fluent

(5) All bicycles parked in the emergency lane will be removed ( ) notice.

1 within **2** beyond **3** beneath **4** without

(6) We still have ( ) space in the trunk for two more sleeping bags.

1 plenty of **2** a great many **3** a number of **4** several

(7) Ms. Hori took ( ) of the sunny weekend to wash all the winter blankets.

1 benefit **2** advantage **3** profit **4** account

(8) Not only the cast members ( ) the stage crew received loud applause.

1 as well **2** and also **3** but also **4** or else

(9) With her arms ( ), the chess player studied the board for five minutes.

1 fold **2** folded **3** folding **4** folds

(10) At first ( ), the two mushroom species look identical, so never pick them.

1 watch **2** stare **3** gaze **4** glance

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(11) Were I in your position, I would (　　) Mr. Noda for advice right away.

1 ask　**2** asked　**3** asking　**4** have asked

(12) The potter rejected three bowls because they did not come up (　　) her standard.

1 into　**2** with　**3** to　**4** under

(13) Our train was held at the platform for six minutes due to a signal (　　).

1 fortune　**2** fame　**3** favor　**4** failure

(14) Before signing a gym contract, read the cancellation rules in (　　).

1 common　**2** short　**3** detail　**4** public

(15) Scarcely had we stepped under the station roof (　　) hail began to fall.

1 than　**2** when　**3** that　**4** until

2

会話文の空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(16) A: Excuse me. Does this bus pass let me ride the harbor ropeway too?
B: (　　) However, showing the pass gets you twenty percent off the ropeway fare.
A: Twenty percent off is still nice—thanks!

1 The ropeway requires a separate ticket.
2 Yes, ride it as many times as you like for free.
3 The ropeway closed fifty years ago.
4 Buses don't run in this city.

(17) A: Why did Coach Takahashi end soccer practice twenty minutes early today?
B: (　　) Everyone hurried inside before the thunder started.
A: Smart move—safety comes first.

1 The soccer ball turned square.
2 Because it was sunny and calm.
3 Nobody came to school today.
4 Distant lightning flashed behind the hills.

(18) A: Shall I print thirty color copies of our club's summer schedule?
B: (　　) Black-and-white saves toner and is just as easy to read.
A: Good point—I'll switch the printer setting.

1 Yes, print a hundred color posters.
2 Let's stick with black-and-white.
3 We don't have a summer schedule.
4 Printers are made of plastic.

(19) A: How did your grandmother react when she saw the photo album you made?
B: (　　) She spent an hour telling us stories behind every picture!
A: What a heartwarming gift.

1 She hasn't been born yet.
2 She threw it away without opening it.
3 She was moved almost to tears!
4 Photos are taken with cameras.

(20) A: Is it alright if I return your graphing calculator tomorrow morning?
B: (　　) Our next physics lab isn't until Thursday.
A: Phew, thanks for letting me finish tonight's worksheet!

1 Take your time—tomorrow is totally fine.
2 No, I need it five minutes ago.
3 Calculators cannot add numbers.
4 Thursday was yesterday.

3

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Passenger Airplanes Have Tiny Holes in Their Windows

Next time you settle into a window seat on a passenger jet, look near the bottom center of the clear pane: you will spot a tiny hole scarcely wider than a toothpick. Nervous flyers sometimes wonder whether the window is cracked, yet aerospace engineers call this feature a "bleed hole," and it is built into cabin windows on purpose.

A jetliner window actually consists of three separate layers of transparent acrylic resin. The thin inner pane facing your elbow is merely a protective scratch shield, whereas the thick outer pane bears the massive air-pressure difference between the thin atmosphere ten kilometers up and the pressurized passenger cabin. If both the outer and middle panes felt full cabin pressure all the time, both would suffer wear together. The tiny hole in the middle pane equalizes air pressure safely so that (21).

The bleed hole performs a neat everyday job too. Outside air at cruising altitude drops below minus fifty degrees Celsius. Allowing dry cabin air to circulate slowly between the panes prevents moisture from freezing onto the outer glass, ensuring passengers enjoy (22).

(21)

1 cabin air escapes into space within thirty seconds

2 outside wind blows loudly onto passengers' knees during takeoff

3 the thin inner scratch shield holds the entire weight of the wings

4 the outer pane carries normal flight loads while the middle pane stays fresh as an emergency backup

(22)

1 a clear, frost-free view of the clouds and landscape below

2 free ice cubes scraped from the inside of the cabin

3 warmer engine exhaust inside their overhead bins

4 complete darkness even at noon

4 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Volunteer Shift Guide for the Town Marathon Water Station

From: Kawa-machi Marathon Organizing Committee
To: High School Volunteer Team (Station 3 – 10 km Mark)
Subject: How to hand cups smoothly to runners this Sunday

Dear Station 3 volunteers,
Thank you for helping staff the 10-kilometer water table for Sunday's Kawa-machi Half Marathon! Nearly 1,800 runners will pass our table between 9:25 a.m. and 10:30 a.m., so smooth teamwork will keep everyone safe.

Please fill paper cups only two-thirds full—full cups splash onto runners' shoes and make the asphalt slippery. When offering a cup, do NOT hold it tightly by the rim from below; instead, pinch the top edge lightly from the side with two fingers, call out "Water!" or "Sports drink!" clearly, and walk two steps forward alongside the runner as they grab it.

Wear waterproof sneakers and meet at the 10 km tent at 8:15 a.m. for table setup!

Organizing Committee

Volunteer Shift Guide for the Town Marathon Water Station — Questions

(23) Why should paper cups be filled only two-thirds full?

1 The town ran out of tap water this week.

2 Full cups spill easily onto shoes and make the road surface slippery.

3 Runners are only allowed one sip by marathon law.

4 Paper cups melt if filled to the top.

(24) How should volunteers hold and hand a cup to an approaching runner?

1 Set all cups on the ground across the middle of the road.

2 Grip the bottom tightly with both hands and stand completely still.

3 Pinch the top edge lightly from the side, call out the drink type, and walk two steps with the runner.

4 Toss cups from three meters away.

(25) What time should volunteers gather at the 10 km tent on Sunday?

1 At 9:25 a.m.

2 At 8:15 a.m.

3 At 10:30 a.m.

4 At noon.

Why Botanical Illustrators Still Draw Plants by Hand

Modern smartphones and macro cameras can photograph an orchid petal in a fraction of a second, capturing millions of pixels of color. Given such effortless technology, visitors to natural history museums are often surprised to learn that botanists naming a newly discovered plant species still commission black-and-white pen-and-ink illustrations drawn by hand.

A single photograph, however sharp, shows only one individual plant at one moment in time. In the wild, a flower may bloom in April while its seed pod matures in August, or one leaf may be chewed by insects while a diagnostic root tuber stays hidden underground. Even worse, camera lenses struggle with depth of field at close range: focusing sharply on tiny pollen stamens blurs the stem hairs two centimeters behind them.

A trained botanical illustrator overcomes all of these limits on one sheet of paper. Consulting closely with the botanist—and often examining pressed herbarium specimens under a microscope—the artist combines buds, open blossoms, cross-sections of fruit, and magnified seed textures side by side in crystal-clear focus. Unnecessary shadows and distracting background leaves are omitted so another scientist a century later can verify the exact vein pattern that distinguishes the species from close relatives.

Digital tablets have certainly joined traditional crow-quill pens on many illustrators' desks, making revisions cleaner. Yet the core skill remains human observation rather than button-pressing: deciding which tiny details matter scientifically.

Far from competing, photography and hand illustration complement each other—photos record living color in habitat, while botanical line art preserves clear structural truth.

Why Botanical Illustrators Still Draw Plants by Hand — Questions

(26) What limitation of a single close-up photograph is explained in the second paragraph?

1 Lenses work only on sunny afternoons at noon.

2 Cameras cannot record green or yellow colors.

3 Photographs fade completely within twenty-four hours.

4 It shows only one moment and struggles to keep both foreground stamens and deeper stem hairs in sharp focus.

(27) How can a single botanical illustration show more life-cycle information than one wild snapshot?

1 It places buds, open flowers, mature fruit cross-sections, and magnified seeds side by side on one page.

2 It uses glow-in-the-dark paint that moves at night.

3 It glues real soil and live insects onto museum walls.

4 It prints three hundred pages per flower.

(28) Why do botanical illustrators leave out distracting background leaves and shadows?

1 Because illustrators do not know how to draw shadows.

2 Because black ink costs more than gold.

3 So future scientists can clearly see the exact structural features that separate the species from relatives.

4 To finish every drawing in under ten seconds.

(29) How does the author view the relationship between photography and hand-drawn botanical art?

1 Photography will replace all museum specimens next year.

2 Hand illustration has made cameras completely useless in nature.

3 Digital tablets banned botanists from using microscopes.

4 They complement each other, with photos capturing living color and line drawings clarifying structure.